

```html

# Network Security Hardening (NSX) — Statement of Work

Version: 1.0 | Date: January 2025 | Status: Final

## 1. ENGAGEMENT OVERVIEW

This engagement enables **NSX Distributed Firewall (DFW)** across four hospital locations within a regional healthcare network serving 12,000 patients daily, implementing microsegmentation by workload type to achieve **HIPAA compliance** and eliminate east-west lateral movement threats before the Q2 audit. The organization currently operates with NSX-T deployed but DFW disabled, creating significant ransomware risk following two incidents in 18 months totaling \$2.1M in downtime costs.

| FIELD           | DETAIL                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engagement Type | Network Security Hardening — NSX Distributed Firewall & vDefend ATP                                                                       |
| Industry        | Healthcare                                                                                                                                |
| Engagement Size | \$320,000 Medium Engagement (14-week deployment)                                                                                          |
| Duration        | 14 weeks (Phase 1 kickoff through Hospital 4 production completion)                                                                       |
| Delivery Model  | Hybrid: On-site Phase 1 kickoff, Phases 2–3 lab-based, Phases 4–5 on-site production deployment with remote support                       |
| Engagement Lead | Solutions Architect — CISO engagement and executive reporting; Technical Program Manager — Epic coordination and compliance documentation |

## 2. ENGAGEMENT OBJECTIVE

Enable **NSX DFW** with microsegmentation across clinical, administrative, and IoT medical device workloads at all four hospital locations, deploy **vDefend ATP** for east-west threat detection and visibility, and deliver a **HIPAA audit evidence package** demonstrating control implementation before Q2 compliance review. Success requires coordinated Epic vendor approval, lab validation of all policies, security team training, and phased production rollout with documented rollback capabilities.

## 3. SCOPE OF WORK

This statement of work encompasses NSX DFW architecture design, lab-based validation, vDefend ATP deployment and tuning, HIPAA documentation, medical IoT inventory and segmentation, Epic vendor coordination, security team training, and production implementation across four hospitals with change management integration.

| WORKSTREAM                                      | DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                 | KEY ACTIVITIES                                                                                                                    | IN SCOPE   |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>NSX DFW Architecture &amp; Design</b>        | Define security group hierarchy, rule architecture, inter-hospital connectivity, and IoT segmentation strategy with deny-by-default posture                 | Current state documentation, workload mapping, security group design, DFW rule hierarchy, allow-list approach for medical devices | ✓ Included |
| <b>Lab Validation &amp; Testing</b>             | Comprehensive testing of DFW policies, IoT communication, clinical-to-admin isolation, failover scenarios, and rollback procedures across all 4 hospitals   | Test plan development, policy build-out, scenario execution, results documentation, design refinement                             | ✓ Included |
| <b>vDefend ATP Deployment</b>                   | Deploy threat detection across all locations, establish baseline tuning, configure alert routing to SIEM, and develop hospital-specific detection baselines | Topology design, sensor deployment, SIEM integration, alert tuning, incident response playbooks                                   | ✓ Included |
| <b>Medical IoT Inventory &amp; Segmentation</b> | Complete device inventory across 4 locations with criticality ratings, communication requirements, and security group assignments                           | Network discovery, vendor coordination, device classification, endpoint mapping, monitoring requirements                          | ✓ Included |
| <b>HIPAA Audit Documentation</b>                | Compliance evidence package mapping NSX DFW controls to HIPAA Security Rule requirements with policy screenshots, system logs, and change audit trail       | Control matrix development, compliance officer review, evidence collection, audit trail formatting                                | ✓ Included |
| <b>Epic Vendor Coordination</b>                 | Prepare change request documentation, coordinate vendor approval, and manage Epic workflow integration for DFW deployment windows                           | Technical documentation, risk mitigation planning, change request submission, approval tracking                                   | ✓ Included |
| <b>Security Team Training</b>                   | Hands-on workshop covering DFW policy lifecycle, vDefend ATP operations, incident response, and change management procedures                                | Training delivery (2 resources × 16 hours), lab exercises, knowledge transfer, documentation                                      | ✓ Included |

| WORKSTREAM                         | DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                            | KEY ACTIVITIES                                                                                  | IN SCOPE                   |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Production Implementation          | Phased rollout across 4 hospital locations with change windows, deployment execution, validation, and rollback testing                 | Phase 4–5 deployment execution, monitoring, validation, post-deployment documentation           | ✓ Included                 |
| Legacy System Remediation Planning | Identify Windows XP systems, document communication requirements, design segmentation approach with compliance exemption documentation | System inventory, requirement mapping, security group design, exemption rationale documentation | ✓ Included (planning only) |

**Out of scope:** Windows XP system patching or decommissioning; medical device firmware updates or upgrades; vSAN or compute infrastructure changes; Epic EHR system modifications; HIPAA compliance program development beyond NSX controls; physical network infrastructure upgrades; custom monitoring dashboard development beyond standard vDefend ATP console.

4. DELIVERABLES

Nine primary deliverables address architecture, testing validation, threat detection deployment, compliance documentation, IoT inventory mapping, vendor coordination, operations training, and production deployment planning. All documentation follows healthcare data security standards and supports Q2 audit requirements.

| # | DELIVERABLE                                  | DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | FORMAT              | QTY | EST. EFFORT (HRS) |
|---|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-----|-------------------|
| 1 | NSX DFW Architecture & Security Group Design | Detailed architecture document with security group structure by workload type (clinical, administrative, IoT), DFW rule hierarchy, inter-hospital connectivity rules, and allow-list segmentation strategy for medical devices | Document (Word/PDF) | 1   | 56                |
| 2 | Lab Validation Test Plan & Results           | Comprehensive test scenarios: clinical-to-admin isolation, IoT device communication validation, failover testing, rollback execution with pass/fail documentation and design issue remediation                                 | Document (Word/PDF) | 1   | 80                |
| 3 | vDefend ATP Deployment & Configuration Guide | Step-by-step deployment procedures for 4 locations, baseline threat detection tuning parameters, alert routing to SIEM, sample detection scenarios, and hospital-specific workload baselines                                   | Document (Word/PDF) | 1   | 48                |

| #                               | DELIVERABLE                                                       | DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                                                               | FORMAT                               | QTY             | EST. EFFORT (HRS) |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| 4                               | <b>HIPAA Audit Evidence Package</b>                               | Control matrices mapping NSX DFW to HIPAA Security Rule (164.308-314), active policy screenshots, system logs demonstrating segmentation enforcement, change audit trail, and compliance officer sign-off | Document (Word/PDF)                  | 1               | 40                |
| 5                               | <b>Medical IoT Device Inventory &amp; Segmentation Mapping</b>    | Complete device inventory across 4 locations: device type, manufacturer, model, criticality rating, required communication endpoints, assigned security groups, and monitoring requirements               | Document + Spreadsheet               | 1               | 32                |
| 6                               | <b>Epic Approval &amp; Change Management Coordination Package</b> | Pre-populated Epic vendor change request form with technical details, risk mitigation plan, testing approach, and escalation contacts to expedite approval                                                | Document (Word/PDF)                  | 1               | 24                |
| 7                               | <b>Security Team Operations Training</b>                          | Hands-on workshop: DFW policy creation/modification/troubleshooting, vDefend ATP console navigation, incident response workflows, change management procedures. Delivered to 2 resources × 8 hours        | Workshop + Recording + Lab Exercises | 1 (2 attendees) | 32                |
| 8                               | <b>Rollback Procedures &amp; Playbooks</b>                        | Step-by-step rollback instructions for each change window, pre-change state capture procedures, validation checklist, and documented rollback test results                                                | Document (Word/PDF)                  | 1               | 28                |
| 9                               | <b>Production Implementation Plan with Change Windows</b>         | Phased rollout schedule across 4 locations with change window timing, Epic approval gates, testing gates, contingency procedures, and hospital-specific deployment sequence                               | Document (Word/PDF) + Gantt          | 1               | 32                |
| <b>TOTAL DELIVERABLE EFFORT</b> |                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                      |                 | <b>372 hrs</b>    |

## 5. WORK BREAKDOWN & SCHEDULE

The engagement spans five phases over 14 weeks: Phase 1 establishes discovery and Epic coordination (weeks 1–3); Phase 2 validates design in lab and secures vendor approval (weeks 4–7); Phase 3 prepares vDefend ATP and trains security team (weeks 8–9); Phase 4 executes Hospital 1 production deployment (weeks 10–11); Phase 5 completes Hospitals 2–4 with inter-location validation (weeks 12–14).

| PHASE                                                                 | ACTIVITY                                                                                                                            | OWNER                                  | DURATION                            | HOURS          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Phase 1: Discovery, Design &amp; Epic Coordination (Weeks 1–3)</b> |                                                                                                                                     |                                        |                                     |                |
| 1.1                                                                   | Kickoff meeting with CISO, Network Director, compliance officer; establish weekly status cadence                                    | Solutions Architect                    | Week 1                              | 8              |
| 1.2                                                                   | Complete medical IoT device inventory across 4 locations via network scanning and vendor coordination                               | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         | Weeks 1–2                           | 40             |
| 1.3                                                                   | Document current NSX-T configuration, DFW disabled state, and workload distribution across locations                                | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         | Weeks 1–2                           | 24             |
| 1.4                                                                   | Map clinical, administrative, and IoT workloads to proposed security groups; design DFW rule hierarchy with deny-by-default posture | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         | Weeks 2–3                           | 32             |
| 1.5                                                                   | Initiate Epic vendor approval process with draft change request and technical documentation                                         | Technical Program Manager              | Weeks 1–2                           | 16             |
| 1.6                                                                   | Reserve and validate dedicated lab environment for NSX testing; confirm exclusive allocation for 6-week window                      | Solutions Architect                    | Week 1                              | 6              |
| <b>Phase 1 Subtotal</b>                                               |                                                                                                                                     |                                        |                                     | <b>126 hrs</b> |
| <b>Phase 2: Design Validation &amp; Lab Testing (Weeks 4–7)</b>       |                                                                                                                                     |                                        |                                     |                |
| 2.1                                                                   | Build DFW policies in lab environment matching production architecture for all 4 hospitals                                          | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) | Weeks 4–5                           | 48             |
| 2.2                                                                   | Execute comprehensive test plan: clinical-to-admin isolation, IoT device communication, failover scenarios, rollback validation     | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) | Weeks 5–6                           | 56             |
| 2.3                                                                   | Document test results, identify design issues, execute remediation and re-test in lab                                               | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         | Week 6                              | 24             |
| 2.4                                                                   | Obtain Epic vendor approval sign-off with formal change request authorization                                                       | Technical Program Manager              | Weeks 4–7 (risk: 4–8 weeks assumed) | 8              |
| 2.5                                                                   | Prepare HIPAA audit documentation templates and control matrix framework                                                            | Technical Program Manager              | Week 7                              | 16             |

| PHASE                                                         | ACTIVITY                                                                                                                   | OWNER                                                | DURATION    | HOURS   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------|
| Phase 2 Subtotal                                              |                                                                                                                            |                                                      |             | 152 hrs |
| Phase 3: vDefend ATP Preparation & Training (Weeks 8–9)       |                                                                                                                            |                                                      |             |         |
| 3.1                                                           | Design vDefend ATP deployment topology and architecture for 4 hospital locations                                           | NSX Operations/vDefend ATP Specialist                | Week 8      | 16      |
| 3.2                                                           | Prepare lab environment for ATP testing, sensor deployment, and baseline tuning                                            | NSX Operations/vDefend ATP Specialist                | Week 8      | 12      |
| 3.3                                                           | Conduct hands-on security team training (2 resources): DFW lifecycle, ATP operations, incident response, change management | Solutions Architect + NSX Security Engineer (Design) | Week 9      | 32      |
| 3.4                                                           | Develop detection tuning baselines specific to clinical, administrative, and IoT workloads using hospital traffic patterns | NSX Operations/vDefend ATP Specialist                | Week 9      | 20      |
| 3.5                                                           | Create incident response playbooks for ATP alert triage and escalation workflows                                           | NSX Security Engineer (Design)                       | Week 9      | 12      |
| 3.6                                                           | Complete HIPAA control mapping and documentation with compliance officer review                                            | Technical Program Manager                            | Week 9      | 16      |
| Phase 3 Subtotal                                              |                                                                                                                            |                                                      |             | 108 hrs |
| Phase 4: Production Implementation — Hospital 1 (Weeks 10–11) |                                                                                                                            |                                                      |             |         |
| 4.1                                                           | Execute DFW policy deployment to Hospital 1 NSX Manager with Epic approval gates and change window execution               | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation)               | Week 10     | 16      |
| 4.2                                                           | Deploy vDefend ATP sensors in Hospital 1 environment with SIEM integration and baseline alert tuning                       | NSX Operations/vDefend ATP Specialist                | Week 10     | 12      |
| 4.3                                                           | Monitor east-west traffic visibility; validate clinical, administrative, and IoT segmentation enforcement                  | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation)               | Week 11     | 20      |
| 4.4                                                           | Execute rollback test to confirm procedure effectiveness and document baseline traffic metrics                             | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation)               | Week 11     | 12      |
| 4.5                                                           | Weekly CISO status report and escalation management                                                                        | Solutions Architect                                  | Weeks 10–11 | 4       |

| PHASE                                                                | ACTIVITY                                                                                                      | OWNER                                  | DURATION    | HOURS   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------|---------|
| Phase 4 Subtotal                                                     |                                                                                                               |                                        |             | 64 hrs  |
| Phase 5: Production Implementation — Hospitals 2, 3, 4 (Weeks 12–14) |                                                                                                               |                                        |             |         |
| 5.1                                                                  | Repeat DFW and ATP deployment for Hospital 2 with 1-week interval and inter-hospital connectivity validation  | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) | Week 12     | 28      |
| 5.2                                                                  | Repeat DFW and ATP deployment for Hospital 3 with cross-hospital failover testing                             | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) | Week 13     | 28      |
| 5.3                                                                  | Repeat DFW and ATP deployment for Hospital 4; complete vDefend ATP deployment across all locations            | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) | Week 14     | 28      |
| 5.4                                                                  | Finalize HIPAA audit evidence package with production proof of implementation and compliance officer sign-off | Technical Program Manager              | Week 14     | 12      |
| 5.5                                                                  | Complete legacy Windows XP system identification and segmentation documentation with compliance exemptions    | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         | Week 14     | 8       |
| 5.6                                                                  | Weekly CISO status reports (Weeks 12–14) and final engagement closeout                                        | Solutions Architect                    | Weeks 12–14 | 6       |
| Phase 5 Subtotal                                                     |                                                                                                               |                                        |             | 110 hrs |
| TOTAL ENGAGEMENT HOURS                                               |                                                                                                               |                                        |             | 560 hrs |

6. MILESTONES & ACCEPTANCE

Ten key milestones track progress from discovery through production completion and audit readiness. Acceptance of each phase requires documented evidence review and stakeholder sign-off.

| # | MILESTONE                          | ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA                                                                                                                                       | TARGET WEEK | OWNER                          |
|---|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------|
| 1 | Phase 1 Kickoff Complete           | CISO, Network Director, compliance officer, and Epic liaison attended kickoff; weekly status cadence established; lab environment allocated and confirmed | Week 1      | Solutions Architect            |
| 2 | Medical IoT Inventory 95% Complete | Device inventory spreadsheet contains manufacturer, model, criticality, communication requirements for ≥95% of hospital medical devices                   | Week 2      | NSX Security Engineer (Design) |

| #  | MILESTONE                                    | ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA                                                                                                                                                                               | TARGET WEEK    | OWNER                                  |
|----|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------|
| 3  | <b>Epic Change Request Submitted</b>         | Formal Epic vendor change request submitted with complete technical documentation, risk mitigation plan, and testing approach                                                                     | Week 2         | Technical Program Manager              |
| 4  | <b>NSX DFW Architecture Design Approved</b>  | Network Director reviewed and signed-off on security group design, DFW rule hierarchy, inter-hospital connectivity rules, and IoT allow-list approach                                             | Week 3         | NSX Security Engineer (Design)         |
| 5  | <b>Lab Validation Test Plan Executed</b>     | All test scenarios executed in lab with documented results; clinical-admin isolation, IoT communication, and failover scenarios validated; design issues remediated and re-tested                 | Week 6         | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) |
| 6  | <b>Epic Vendor Approval Received</b>         | Epic formal change request approval email received with authorization to deploy DFW policies to production environments                                                                           | Week 7         | Technical Program Manager              |
| 7  | <b>Security Team Training Completed</b>      | 2 security team resources completed 8-hour hands-on training; DFW policy creation, ATP alert triage, and incident response workflows demonstrated; lab exercises passed                           | Week 9         | Solutions Architect                    |
| 8  | <b>Hospital 1 DFW &amp; ATP Live</b>         | DFW policies enforced in Hospital 1 NSX Manager; vDefend ATP sensors operational; east-west visibility achieved with zero unplanned downtime; rollback test passed; baseline metrics documented   | Week 11        | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) |
| 9  | <b>Hospitals 2–4 Deployment Complete</b>     | DFW policies active and validated across Hospitals 2, 3, 4; vDefend ATP deployed to all 4 locations; inter-hospital connectivity confirmed; no security incidents; all rollback procedures tested | Week 14        | NSX Security Engineer (Implementation) |
| 10 | <b>HIPAA Audit Evidence Package Approved</b> | <b>Compliance officer reviewed and signed-off on control matrices, policy screenshots, system logs, and change audit trail; package submitted to audit team</b>                                   | <b>Week 14</b> | <b>Technical Program Manager</b>       |

## 7. ASSUMPTIONS

This statement of work is based on ten key assumptions regarding vendor approval timelines, infrastructure stability, resource availability, and audit readiness. The mitigation strategies below address specific risks if assumptions prove invalid.

| # | ASSUMPTION                                                                                                                                                                             | DEPENDENCY                                                             | RISK IF INVALID & MITIGATION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Epic Vendor Approval within 3 Weeks:</b> Epic formal change request approval granted by week 7 with no major technical objections                                                   | Phase 1 change request submission; Epic contact engagement             | <b>Risk:</b> Epic approval historically requires 4–8 weeks for formal change review. If approval slips to weeks 8–10, Phase 4 Hospital 1 deployment must compress or slide to week 12. <b>Mitigation:</b> Submit change request at Phase 1 kickoff (week 1). Establish executive vendor relationship through CISO engagement. Identify alternate Hospital 1 change windows in weeks 11 or 12 to maintain 14-week completion target. Pre-stage all policies in Hospital 1 lab-equivalent before approval received.                                                                                  |
| 2 | <b>Medical IoT Inventory 95%+ Complete in 2 Weeks:</b> Systematic discovery across 4 locations yields ≥95% device inventory by end of week 2                                           | Phase 1 discovery completion; DFW rule design finalization             | <b>Risk:</b> Medical device inventory often requires 3–4 weeks including vendor coordination and legacy system discovery. At 60% completion by week 2, DFW rule design gaps emerge in Phase 2. <b>Mitigation:</b> Allocate dedicated discovery resources at kickoff (network engineer + vendor liaison). Execute systematic network scanning (UPnP/SNMP) concurrently with vendor contacts. Create dynamic security group for unknown IoT devices with restrictive logging to identify gaps post-deployment. Plan 3-week discovery window with flexible Phase 2 gate if inventory slips to week 3. |
| 3 | <b>Exclusive Lab Environment Allocation:</b> Dedicated lab NSX environment available for 6-week testing window (weeks 4–9) with no competing workload conflicts                        | Phase 2 policy build and validation; Phase 3 ATP testing               | <b>Risk:</b> Shared lab environment conflicts in weeks 5–7 prevent adequate DFW policy testing before Hospital 1 production deployment, compressing Phase 2 gate. <b>Mitigation:</b> Secure written lab allocation commitment at kickoff. If lab conflicts persist in week 3, identify backup cloud-based NSX lab (e.g., VMware HOL environment) or split testing across shared capacity with staggered schedules. Front-load critical policy testing into weeks 4–5 before conflict windows. Accept reduced lab time and increase Hospital 1 production rollback contingency hours.               |
| 4 | <b>NSX-T Platform Stability:</b> Current NSX-T deployment is stable; DFW enablement will not require underlying vSAN, network, or compute infrastructure changes during 14-week window | Phase 1 NSX configuration assessment; Phases 4–5 production deployment | <b>Risk:</b> Unplanned vSAN or network infrastructure upgrades during phase 4–5 could delay Hospital 1 deployment. <b>Mitigation:</b> Confirm NSX-T and dependent infrastructure upgrade schedule with Network Director during Phase 1 kickoff. Identify blackout windows (e.g., Q1 fiscal year-end patching) and schedule Hospital 1 deployment outside conflict periods. Add 1-week buffer in Phase 4 timeline for infrastructure delay recovery.                                                                                                                                                |

| # | ASSUMPTION                                                                                                                                                           | DEPENDENCY                           | RISK IF INVALID & MITIGATION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 | <b>vDefend ATP Licensing Included:</b><br>vDefend ATP licensing is included in current NSX-T subscription or can be procured within first week at no additional cost | Phase 3 ATP deployment authorization | <b>Risk:</b> vDefend ATP licensing not included; procurement requires 3–4 weeks and adds \$40K–\$60K cost. <b>Mitigation:</b> Verify NSX-T subscription details with VMware account team within 48 hours of engagement start. If ATP licensing not included, initiate procurement order immediately and adjust Phase 3 timeline to week 11. Consider ATP functionality limitations during Hospital 1 deployment if licensing delayed (e.g., deploy without ATP, enable in Hospital 2–4 phase). |

6

*This Statement of Work is generated as a draft for review and is subject to legal review, customer negotiation, and final approval before execution. Commercial terms, pricing, and signatures are placeholders and must be completed prior to contract execution. Generated by AgentPM SOW Orchestrator · Daniel Mazzini · Principal Architect & Senior TPM.*

 **Scope approved with 4 warnings — proceeding to SOW drafting**

Brief is well-structured with strong governance and risk planning, but contains timeline compression risks, unrealistic team capacity assumptions, and budget insufficiency for stated scope that require executive alignment before SOW drafting.

Agent 3 will incorporate these warnings into the SOW risk register.

**CONTRADICTION**

**Budget vs. Scope Mismatch**  
Estimated budget range \$150K–\$500K with 5-person team (2 NSX engineers, 1 ATP specialist, 1 PM, 1 solutions architect) over 14 weeks suggests ~\$320K mid-point, which is insufficient for full scope including vDefend ATP licensing, 4-location deployment, training, and HIPAA documentation package. Risk mitigation in brief acknowledges budget constraint but offers only deferrals. — **Fix:** Clarify approved budget ceiling and prioritize scope accordingly in SOW, or increase budget estimate to \$450K–\$550K. Confirm vDefend ATP licensing status immediately—if not included, procurement cost could exceed \$50K+.

**CONTRADICTION**

**Team Capacity vs. Customer Dependency**  
Brief assumes customer security team dedicates 50% capacity (2 resources = 1 FTE) plus Network Director, Epic liaison, compliance officer, and clinical leadership for vendor approval, change windows, and testing. This

creates 4+ customer resource dependencies while 14-week timeline has zero buffer. Phase 1-2 overlap (3+4 weeks = 7 weeks for discovery, design, and lab validation) is aggressive for 4-hospital IoT inventory and Epic vendor approval. — **Fix:** Confirm customer resource commitments in writing with escalation matrix. Reduce Phase 1 duration to 2 weeks or extend Phase 2 to 5 weeks to accommodate realistic inventory and approval timelines. Identify backup customer contacts for Epic and compliance officer roles.

#### AMBIGUITY

##### vDefend ATP False Positive Risk Underspecified

Risk register identifies ATP baseline tuning as 'conservative' in mitigation but Phase 3 allocates only 2 weeks for 'detection tuning baselines specific to hospital workloads.' Hospital environments have unique traffic patterns (medical devices, EHR, clinical workflows) requiring 2-4 weeks tuning after Hospital 1 deployment. Current plan front-loads tuning before production, which may not capture real traffic patterns. — **Fix:** Revise Phase 4 to include 2-week 'ATP Tuning and Validation' period after Hospital 1 deployment before rolling out to Hospitals 2-4. Extend timeline to 16 weeks or reduce scope to ATP deployment without advanced tuning in initial 14-week window.

#### UNREALISTIC

##### Zero Unplanned Downtime Success Criterion

Success criteria requires 'zero unplanned downtime' across 4 hospital locations with DFW enablement, rollback testing, and ATP deployment. Healthcare networks typically experience 5-15 minutes unplanned downtime per major change. Criterion is unmeasurable and sets engagement up for failure despite excellent execution. — **Fix:** Revise success criterion to 'Zero unplanned downtime exceeding 15 minutes per change window' or 'All unplanned downtime documented and mitigation executed within 30 minutes.' Define acceptable RTO/RPO for each hospital location in Phase 1.

#### RISK

##### Epic Vendor Approval Bottleneck

Assumes Epic approval granted within 3 weeks with 'no major technical objections,' but healthcare vendors often require 4-8 weeks for formal change reviews. Compressed timeline provides no contingency. Brief states Phase 1 is 3 weeks and Phase 2 includes 'Obtain Epic vendor approval sign-off'—if approval slips to week 5-6, entire Phase 3-5 schedule compresses.

#### RISK

##### Medical IoT Inventory Dependency

DFW rule design cannot finalize until IoT inventory is 95% complete. Phase 1 allocates 2 weeks for discovery across 4 hospitals with 'systematic discovery,' but inventory of medical devices often takes 3-4 weeks with vendor coordination. Gap in Phase 1 timeline creates Phase 2 design delays.

#### RISK

##### Compliance Officer Dependency Introduced Late

Open item notes 'Compliance officer availability confirmation' required, yet HIPAA audit documentation is critical path deliverable due Q2. If compliance officer is unavailable or changes roles mid-engagement, audit evidence package delivery at risk. Brief does not identify backup compliance resource or documentation template escalation path.

#### RISK

##### Lab Environment Escalation Clause Weak

Assumption states 'Shared lab environment conflict will be resolved in customer's favor or alternative lab capacity provided,' but this is contingent, not confirmed. If lab conflicts persist in weeks 3-6, testing gate delays entire Phase 2 and compressed timeline to 12 weeks may jeopardize Hospital 1 deployment quality.

**Validated scope items:** Comprehensive 10-item risk register with mitigation strategies shows strong risk planning · Detailed phased approach (5 phases) with clear gates and hospital-by-hospital sequencing · Strong governance model with weekly CISO reporting and executive Epic/compliance coordination · 9 substantive deliverables including HIPAA audit package and rollback procedures demonstrate compliance focus